as a mother and wife, while continuing with my job. The support and encouragement of my husband, my parents and in-laws made it possible for me to balance home and career.

The winds of economic liberalization were sweeping across India at the time. In the course of my interactions with senior bureaucrats, I was often requested to submit white papers on various topics. I loved dealing with such policy challenges, and so resigned from my job and set up a think tank to provide policy inputs, to both corporates and the government. Post the 1992 liberalization, ABN AMRO approached me to head their investment bank in India.

ABN AMRO was one of the world's leading project finance banks. I was happy to join it as this gave me an opportunity to gain the expertise needed for financing the massive infrastructure projects on the horizon – power, telecom, highways, airports, ports, and oil and gas projects. I spent intensive months with the bank's expert teams in Chicago to learn how to structure these long-term, complex financings and understand the risks associated with them.

Over the next five years, our team became the powerhouse of project finance for infrastructure projects in the country. We arranged financing for all the initial telecom operators in India and several major power projects, with due financial prudence. One project I declined to finance was the Dabhol Enron power project, on the grounds that the power purchase agreement was clearly unfair to the Indian consumer and hence could not be economically viable. To my regret, I was overruled and the financing was arranged via Chicago, resulting in large write-offs and losses for the bank.

I feel very proud and privileged to have arranged funding for the power sector, which has led to power sufficiency and the electrification of villages across the country, and for the telecom sector, which has led to a mobile phone in the hand of almost every Indian. One of my most vivid memories of the time was working hard to persuade credit committees in Amsterdam to extend facilities to Indian start-ups in the telecom business. A sceptical colleague who had asked sarcastically if I